Pesto Pantesco

another day in paradise

JESSE JENKINS

JUL 18, 2025 • PAID

30 1

When it's hot and the tomatoes are tomato-ing, make this fresh tomato pes
Pantelleria, a small island off the coast of Sicily and one of my favourite plac
between Sicily and Tunisia, the landscape and food feel completely of their
True to themselves, and to the ingredients that surround them. It's known f
producing incredible capers, wild oregano, almonds, tomatoes, and olive oi
uses them all in a perfect alchemy.

Ingredients, serves 2

150-200g dried pasta - I used bucatini, but busiati or casarecce is tradition
2-3 ripe tomatoes - I used san marzano - cored and diced
1 tbsp capers
1 tbsp sun dried tomatoes
1 small garlic clove
20g toasted or blanched almonds
1 tsp dried oregano
1 handful basil - optional
1 tsp calabrian chilli paste - optional

Plenty of good olive oil
Pinch of salt

Slice the tomatoes in half, then remove the flesh and seeds with a spoon. Fi the remaining tomato and add to a mixing bowl with a pinch of salt. Set asic squeeze any juice from the pulp through a sieve and mix it back through the tomatoes.

[If you dont have a sharp knife, use a serrated bread knife, or a “tomato knife the tomatoes. Its one of my most used knives.]

It makes the process a lot easier and quicker to pre-chop the almonds and tomatoes. If you have a microplane, use that to mince the garlic as well. Add roughly chopped almonds, sun-dried tomatoes, minced garlic, and a pinch

pestle and mortar. You can add the capers too, but I prefer to mix them thro
A 50/50 split works great. Pound with a little olive oil until smooth, then tran
bowl with the tomatoes. Add the capers, dried oregano, and a generous am
olive oil. Mix well and set aside for an hour or two. Even better if you make it
before and keep it in the fridge.

This is often served at room temperature or cold - I love it both ways. I rese
of the pasta water to mix through just as you would with a hot pasta.

Hope you enjoy

Love
-J

Join Jesse Jenkins's subscriber chat

Available in the Substack app and on web

Join chat

30 Likes

Discussion about this post

Comments Restacks

Write a comment...

Jenny 5. aug.

Doubled (more than doubled?) this recipe 1) b/c who the hell makes only 200g of pa
extra for a sandwich tomorrow. Barely let it sit for 45min + was still excellent. Pulsec
processor a few times instead of mortar and pestle b/c no one was watching.

LIKE REPLY

© 2026 Jesse Jenkins · Privacy · Terms · Collection notice
Substack is the home for great culture